

Securities and Exchange Commission, over the course of twenty years, a 1 percent annual fee can reduce the value of your portfolio by about \$30,000. And that's a very conservative number. Many sources report the number to be closer to \$60,000.

We have the internet to thank for the ease of overspending, but it's also made investing easier and much more affordable. And there are very few spending decisions that will save you \$30,000 as easily as managing your own IRA.

Don't Go Broke

If contentment is the radical middle, the ideal marriage between the two extremes, then it's not asking us to abandon aspirations or desire for more. It's also not asking us to ignore the need to rest, pause, and do nothing. Instead, it's taking the good and beautiful on both sides while appreciating the "benefits received" right in front of us.

In every facet of your finances, you can be borrowing from both ends of the spectrum and finding the third option. The solution offered by your "perfect self" on one shoulder and your "unhinged self" on your other shoulder mixed with your own creativity. You can "Lizzie McGuire" this thing, making decisions that work for you as you aim at contentment and financial growth.

When you master your spending, find your enough, and achieve financial goals, you set yourself up for a more content and satisfied outlook. You are also more equipped to make informed and insightful decisions about your stuff, status, and situation.

Just don't fall into the trap of believing you value everything or succumbing to the pressure of achieving all the things, all at once. Also, don't give up! Keep moving forward toward the life you want and the person you want to become, even if you need to take breaks or stretch the timeline a bit. Honor your season, embrace simplicity, lean into your community, invest in the things that matter most, find the radical middle, and look for small ways to immediately enjoy the things money can't buy.